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Digital Literacy Project Report

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Introduction

Digital literacy is an essential skill in today's technology-driven world. It involves the ability to use digital tools, platforms, and the internet safely, effectively, and responsibly. This project focuses on understanding key aspects of digital literacy, including online communication, social media etiquette, cybercrime awareness, and data handling. Through various tasks, I explored how digital platforms impact our daily lives and how important it is to maintain security and ethical behaviour online. The project also highlights common risks such as cyberbullying, phishing, and identity theft, along with ways to prevent them. Overall, this project helped me develop awareness about safe internet practices and responsible digital citizenship.

TASK 1 – Digital Literacy Infographic

The infographic titled “Digital Literacy: Skills for Modern Students” explains the basic knowledge and skills that students need to use digital technology responsibly and effectively. Digital literacy means the ability to use digital tools, communicate safely online, and evaluate information available on the internet. In today’s world, students depend on technology for learning, communication, and collaboration, so understanding digital literacy is very important.

The infographic highlights some useful digital tools that students commonly use. For example, Google Docs helps students write and collaborate on documents, Google Forms can be used to collect surveys and responses, GitHub allows students to manage coding projects, and LinkedIn helps build professional networks and connect with industry professionals.

Another important part of the infographic focuses on safe internet practices. It reminds users not to share sensitive information like OTPs or passwords, to avoid clicking suspicious links, to create strong passwords, and to enable two-factor authentication (2FA) for better security.

Finally, the infographic explains email etiquette, which is important for professional communication. It advises using a clear subject line, being polite and concise in emails, avoiding slang language, and ending emails with a proper sign-off. Overall, the infographic provides a simple guide for students to become responsible and safe digital users.

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

In this task, I created and explored different professional online platforms to build my digital presence as a Computer Science student. A digital portfolio is important because it helps students showcase their skills, projects, and achievements online.

First, I created and updated my GitHub profile, which is widely used by programmers to store and share their coding projects. I uploaded my programming work and learned how to create repositories, add files, and write a README file. GitHub helps developers collaborate and demonstrate their technical skills.

Next, I worked on my LinkedIn profile, which is a professional networking platform. On LinkedIn, I added my educational details, skills, and a short bio. This platform helps students connect with professionals, companies, and recruiters, which can be useful for internships and job opportunities in the future.

I also explored Kaggle, a platform used by programmers and data enthusiasts to practice coding, learn from datasets, and participate in competitions. Even though I am a CSE Core student, Kaggle can help improve analytical and problem-solving skills.

Overall, creating these profiles helped me understand the importance of building a strong digital identity and maintaining a professional online presence.

Task 3 – Coding Platform and Google Form

In this task, I explored a coding platform and created a Google Form to understand how digital tools can be used for learning and collecting information online. Coding platforms are very helpful for Computer Science students because they allow us to practice programming problems and improve our logical thinking skills.

I used an online coding platform to solve programming problems and practice coding in languages such as C++ and Python. These platforms provide different types of challenges that help students strengthen their problem-solving abilities. They also allow users to track their progress and learn new programming concepts.

In addition to this, I created a Google Form to collect responses from people on a specific topic. Google Forms is a simple and useful tool for conducting surveys and gathering information quickly. I designed questions in the form and shared the link so that others could submit their responses easily.

This task helped me understand how coding platforms support skill development and how digital tools like Google Forms can be used to collect data efficiently. It also improved my understanding of using online tools for academic and professional purposes.

Task 4 – Poor Digital Communication Scenario

Poor digital communication can sometimes create misunderstandings and problems. One example of this is when a student sends an email to a professor without following proper email etiquette. For instance, a student might send a message without a subject line, use informal language, or write very short and unclear messages like “Send the assignment details quickly.” Such messages can appear rude or unprofessional and may create a negative impression.

In a professional or academic environment, clear and polite communication is very important. If the student had written the email properly with a clear subject line, respectful greeting, and a well-structured message explaining the request, the communication would have been more effective.

This situation shows that following proper digital communication rules such as being polite, clear, and respectful can help avoid misunderstandings and maintain professionalism in online interactions.

Task 5 - Cybercrime Case Study and Prevention Checklist

- **Case Study**

A common example of cybercrime is phishing fraud. In one case, a college student received an email that appeared to be from a bank asking him to update his account details. The email looked genuine and contained a link that redirected him to a fake website that looked exactly like the official bank website. Without realizing the risk, the student entered his banking username, password, and OTP. Within a few minutes, money was withdrawn from his account by cybercriminals.

This case shows how easily people can become victims of online scams when they trust unknown links or messages. Cybercriminals often design fake emails and websites that look real to trick users into sharing their personal or financial information.

- **Prevention Checklist**

To prevent such cybercrimes, users should follow some basic online safety practices. Always check the sender's email address and verify the authenticity of messages before clicking on any links. Never share sensitive information such as passwords, OTPs, or banking details with anyone. Use strong and unique passwords fo different accounts and enable two-factor authentication for additional security. Avoid accessing sensitive accounts on public Wi-Fi networks. If any suspicious activity occurs, it should be reported immediately through the National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in) or the helpline number 1930.

Being aware and cautious while using the internet can help prevent cybercrime and keep personal information safe.

Conclusion:

This project has enhanced my understanding of digital literacy and its importance in everyday life. I learned how to communicate responsibly on social media, protect personal information, and identify potential cyber threats. The tasks helped me realize that even small mistakes online can lead to serious consequences. By applying the knowledge gained, I can use digital platforms more safely and confidently. This project has also encouraged me to spread awareness about cyber safety among others. Overall, it has been a valuable learning experience that will help me become a responsible and informed digital user.

References

- https://cybercrime.gov.in
- Google Search (for general research)
- Course materials and notes
- Social media platforms (for examples)

Thank you